2024–25 ACADEMIC SENATE PROGRAM REVIEW OF
DEPARTMENT OF ECOLOGY AND EVOLUTIONARY BIOLOGY

Internal Reviewers

Michael Cohen, Review Team Chair, Academic Program Review Committee, English
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External Reviewers

David Ackerly, Integrative Biology, University of California, Berkeley
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Date of Site Visit: April 8-9, 2025

Approved by Academic Program Review Committee: May 20, 2025
Approved by Graduate Council: May 30, 2025
Approved by Undergraduate Council: May 30, 2025

Appendix I: External Reviewers' Report
Appendix II: Site Visit Schedule

Note: The Self-Review Report has been previously distributed. If you would like a copy, please contact programreview@senate.ucla.edu.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Department of Ecology and Evolutionary Biology (EEB) is housed in the College of Letters and Science, Life Sciences Division, and is home to three undergraduate majors (Biology, Marine Biology, and Ecology, Behavior, and Evolution), two undergraduate minors (Conservation Biology and Evolutionary Medicine), a Ph.D. program (Biology), and two M.S. programs (Biology and Ecology and Evolution of Medicine). At the time of the AY24-25 review, the unit was under the leadership of Department Chair Michael Alfaro, under Dean of Life Sciences Tracy Johnson. In the 2024-25 academic year, EEB had 29 faculty, approx. 1,800 majors in three undergraduate degree programs, 71 PhD students, 11 MS students, and 21 postdoctoral scholars.

This report summarizes the perspectives of the Academic Program Review Committee via the internal review team, with reference to the comparative perspectives from the external reviewers on scholarly matters.

The EEB faculty maintain a high level of research excellence, the graduate program trains the next generation of researchers and teachers in the discipline, and the undergraduate programs, which include the Biology major, the fourth largest program in the College, serve a large and diverse student body interested in field research, ecology, marine biology, and careers in health care. As the external evaluators' report states, "the Department of Ecology and Evolutionary Biology at UCLA has a distinguished history as a nationally ranked department spanning critical disciplines of the life sciences, ranging from marine biogeochemistry, to animal behavior, to conservation genomics. The areas encompassed within EEB continue to grow in importance, providing the critical discoveries and training of the next generation to tackle challenges of infectious disease, biodiversity loss, and global change."

The department has faced a series of challenges since 2020. Some of these are national in origin, some are institutional. However, the department's most difficult issue has stemmed from a personnel matter (ongoing as of this writing), which has severely damaged its sense of community, eroded morale among faculty, staff, and students, and, for a period, limited the department's ability to carry on basic operations (among other consequences, delaying this review by two years). The department has emerged from several years of volatility and now enjoys stable leadership, which has done an admirable job instituting new practices, procedures, and policies in the service of rebuilding culture and trust. Rebuilding takes time, however, and there is still much work to be done. It should be the highest priority of upper administration to support the department's leadership so that it can remain stable and continue the work it has begun. Department leadership should in turn seek to involve more constituencies in planning for the department's future.

It is the review team's assessment that the department should be given the resources it needs to recruit and retain faculty, to hire additional staff, and to set up a strategic planning process that will focus on curriculum innovation and pedagogy, as well as developing a plan for future hiring that will focus on contributions to the department's curricula, particularly at the undergraduate level. In addition, the review team recommends that department leadership, in consultation with relevant upper administration offices at UCLA, create a venue or method within or by which department constituencies, perhaps with the guidance of trained mediators, can discuss events that have transpired over the previous five years, while also respecting university policies regarding confidentiality.

The Academic Program Review Committee recommends that **the Progress Review Meeting should not be waived**. The Progress Review Meeting should be held in Spring 2026.

2024–25 ACADEMIC SENATE PROGRAM REVIEW OF
DEPARTMENT OF ECOLOGY AND EVOLUTIONARY BIOLOGY

1. STRUCTURE AND GOVERNANCE

The Department of Ecology and Evolutionary Biology traces its lineage back to the Departments of Zoology and Botany, which were housed in the original College of Agriculture at UCLA in the 1940s. These departments merged in 1970, creating the Department of Biology. After several further shifts, the department was re-named Ecology and Evolutionary Biology in 2004, to reflect its disciplinary focus on quantitative biology, conservation biology, and behavior.

The department's governance structure includes a Chair and four vice-chairs, in graduate studies, undergraduate studies, academic personnel, and community. The administrative structure consists of a Chief Administrative Officer, who oversees staff in finance, operations, research administration, procurement, human resources, academic personnel, academic program coordination, undergraduate and graduate student services, and facilities management.

Strengths and Achievements

Department leadership has done an admirable job stabilizing the department in the wake of a period of prolonged instability, during which there were two outside chairs and several years in which every vice-chair position was unfilled. The hiring of a new CAO in 2024 has brought a measure of stability to the administrative staff after a period of high turnover. Department leadership has improved transparency and uniformity by implementing written procedures for academic personnel review and graduate mentoring. The creation of the Vice Chair for Community and the Committee for Anti-Racism and Equity (CARE) has addressed concerns related to department climate, and the creation of new, low-key social events has sought to improve morale, particularly among graduate students.

The review team heard praise on all sides for Chair Alfaro's efforts guiding the department. Similar praise was given to the CAO for their work leading the administrative staff. The department's leadership in turn expressed a sense of the strong and ongoing support they have received from Dean of Life Sciences Tracy Johnson. It is clear that most of the advances and gains the department has made, particularly since 2022, are due to this stability in leadership and staffing, and it should be the highest priority for upper administration to maintain that stability within the department over the next few years, as members of the leadership team cycle off and new members cycle on. These positions are time-consuming, often difficult jobs; several were described to the review committee as "hot seats," subject to criticism and unhappiness even during ordinary times. The people who hold these positions need to feel that they are supported as they do their work.

Areas in Need of Attention

While the department's culture has improved markedly over the past three years, it remains the case that many constituencies do not share a sense of optimism about things. The interpretation that decisions are made in a "top-down" manner, without meaningful opportunities for input from people not in leadership, was expressed to the review committee on several occasions, as was the belief that some reforms have been "performative" rather than substantive, with a perceived intention of "sweeping things under the rug" rather than fundamentally addressing inequities. There remains a

sense among some that the department's culture is "toxic," "divisive," and "retaliatory." There is a lack of trust among various constituencies within the department, particularly between graduate students and faculty, and there is a perception of widespread inequities, particularly around promotions, the distribution of service labor, and the allotment of teaching. (The previous eight-year review had noted concerns about inequity in promotions and advancements, so some of these issues go back a long way). Some people feel disengaged, and there are suspicions that attempts to address long-standing problems will be temporary and that there will not be accountability or redress for harms that have occurred in the past.

Regarding departmental administration, it is clear that current staffing levels are not adequate for running such a highly complex unit. The review team was repeatedly told of hardships that arose with the departures of several longtime staff members during the review period. One particular area of concern is fund management, where instability and turnover have caused faculty to lose time and productivity. There has been a corresponding increase in friction between faculty and staff, which has caused problems for morale among staff, some of whom have had to take on additional responsibilities to cover unfilled positions and other shortages. These morale issues have been intensified by uncertainties regarding the potential effects on department finances of the Bruin Budget Model and changes to federal funding policies.

2. UNDERGRADUATE PROGRAMS

Strengths and Achievements

The UCLA Ecology and Evolutionary Biology program has a large number of undergraduate majors due in part to its ability to offer field studies. Field training has long been a hallmark of EEB's "specialty" majors; Marine Biology and Ecology, Behavior, and Evolution. Students frequently cited the immersive field courses as the highlight of their undergraduate experience. This is a key strength of the program and one of the few remaining departments in the nation to offer immersive field courses. Students are drawn to UCLA because of these courses, and resources allocated to ensure their continuation should be a priority.

The Biology major is currently the 4th largest undergraduate major in the university, and appeals to many students who intend to pursue careers in health care. The department's other majors (Marine Biology, and Ecology, Evolution, and Behavior), are smaller, with approximately 100 majors each, and these programs seem to align more closely with the department's disciplinary orientation.

The review team met with students from the EBE major only. Overall, they reported a general satisfaction with the program, and highlighted the strength of the program in the hands-on experience with specimens and field research.

The department successfully recruited new junior faculty, allowing many additional undergraduates to obtain research assistant positions to complete capstone projects.

Time to degree for a four-year program is consistently met within the expected 12 registered quarters.

Areas in Need of Attention

Given the university faces increasing pressure to accommodate a larger student body, scaling resource-intensive field experiences has become a significant challenge. Attention should be provided to preserve the field training as a capstone option that would maintain the field studies. Given the potential restraints of resources to meet all students' needs for such a capstone, other alternative experiences should be created that include an intensive lab experience.

The self-study is considering a coursework-only option for the majors. This would offer students a path to gain diverse EEB experiences, including some field exposure, without requiring an intensive research-based capstone and create a path for honors over an intensive research-based capstone. The department should continue to investigate this option.

Despite overall satisfaction, there were several issues raised by the student body and faculty that the department needs to consider and address. The first of these issues is updating the core curriculum courses with expertise that newly recruited faculty bring to the department. One concern is that information is continually being added to courses without taking anything away. Restructuring the required courses with more flexibility in the major was also considered an important issue that needs to be addressed by the department. It was raised that there are more students than courses for majors available, causing significant stress, and many students taking these courses are outside the major. A further recommendation is that the department modify the open enrollment for students in their major before others.

The second area of attention is that some courses now being offered by lecturers were considered of lower quality than when Academic Senate faculty taught them. An example that highlights this point was when a student was told their answer was wrong by the lecturer, but was in fact correct and the TA had to intervene. This highlights that some of the lecturers are not familiar with the course material they are being asked to teach. Another example was student safety. A lecturer teaching one of the field courses did not put a safety plan in place and one student was seriously injured with no first aid or any medical preparedness.

It was raised that undergraduate education is not being considered by the department when new faculty are hired. There are only four marine science faculty remaining in the department. While another member of this group was hired, they also recently left. Exacerbating this issue is that many faculty also do highly demanding service roles, making it difficult to find faculty to teach specific disciplines. This point requires attention from the Dean and the Chair as there does not appear to be a strategic plan for the department.

There is a concern that the climate problems that have cast a dark cloud on the department over the past few years still exist and are affecting undergraduate students, who are being advised not to apply to graduate school in the department because of continued DEI concerns.

3. GRADUATE PROGRAMS

Strengths and Achievements

By many metrics, the graduate program is doing very well. The department can recruit excellent cohorts of students consistently; these students publish research and become highly regarded teachers; for the most part they graduate within six years; and most of them go on to postdocs, NGOs, positions in government, and other occupations within the field. In addition, the department has recruited diverse cohorts of students; the EEB PhD is among the most diverse in Life Sciences, and, per one faculty member's view, is the most diverse EEB program in the country.

The department has made several important innovations to its graduate program since the last eight-year review. These include the implementation of a mentoring compact, a document created in collaboration between graduate students and their advisors that is intended to define adequate degree progress, providing mechanisms for appropriate feedback, and instituting annual review meetings. The CARE committee, although it serves the department as a whole, has addressed many graduate student concerns, including those raised by a grad-student-led climate survey in 2022. The department has also tried to foster a more collegial and supportive atmosphere by providing funding for low-key social events, such as an exhibition of graduate students' artwork.

There have been several attempts to improve communication with graduate students, including regular town halls and the creation of a Graduate Student Association. It remains unclear whether or not these mechanisms have succeeded; the GSA was disbanded after only a few years, and the most recent town hall drew a very small audience. Nevertheless, the faculty have expressed a clear intent to cultivate a better and more supportive departmental environment for graduate students, and these efforts seem to be succeeding, especially with earlier-stage students (i.e., students who enrolled after the 2022 strike). Most of the graduate students who met with the review committee expressed positive feelings about their experiences in the program.

Areas in Need of Attention

Since the previous review, a number of external crises severely damaged the relationship between graduate students and faculty. These include the COVID-19 lockdown and the move to remote instruction in 2020-2021, the protests following the killing of George Floyd in 2020, the strike in the Fall of 2022, and the violence on campus in the Spring of 2024. The effects of these events have been amplified by the fallout from an ongoing conflict within the department, which has had consequences, in some cases quite severe, for the careers of several graduate students.

To put it simply, many graduate students, especially in more advanced cohorts, are suspicious of the faculty. For example, the view was expressed several times to the review committee that department leadership delayed this review by two years with the deliberate intention of excluding several cohorts of graduate students, who graduated in the interim and therefore had much more limited opportunities to share their perspectives on the department. The view was also expressed that current graduate students had to push hard to have alumni voices included in the self-review and site visit. While it seems clear to the committee that exigent circumstances led to the two-year delay in the review, and that there were no overt efforts to exclude anyone, the faculty and the department leadership should understand that many graduate students believe this to be the case.

Some of the more specific concerns that were raised during the site visit include concerns about mentoring, field safety, the curriculum, and a culture of impunity that has allowed abusive conduct toward graduate students to go unaddressed.

Mentoring. Graduate students are enthusiastic about the mentoring compact, but feel that implementation has focused primarily on student compliance rather than faculty compliance, and that this orientation should be reversed so that mechanisms are in place to ensure that faculty will comply with the policy. Graduate students expressed the belief that formal mentorship training should be required for faculty, and that every lab should have a compact that outlines work expectations and norms of conduct.

Field Safety. The review committee was told several concerning stories in which lapses in field safety led to dangerous situations for both undergraduate students and graduate TAs and researchers. One suggestion is that the department should institute a formal field safety training program to be required of all instructors and researchers who lead field courses or conduct field research. But the issue was also framed as deriving from several larger problems in the department. The first is a sense that the quality of undergraduate education, particularly its field study component, has declined over time, and that field courses are now being assigned to instructors who lack the training and expertise to teach them effectively. The second is a sense that these lapses in field safety are connected to a more general lack of respect and concern for the well-being of students that is felt to be manifest among some of the faculty.

Curriculum. There is a sense that the graduate curriculum is outdated and that the department "is not living up to its potential", given the expertise and achievements of the faculty. Concerns were repeatedly expressed about some of the required courses, with a sense that these courses in particular need to be thoroughly revamped. There was also a sense that the procedures by which graduate courses are assigned should be reformed and codified in writing so that seminars can engage a wider array of topics by a greater number of faculty, particularly junior faculty.

Faculty conduct. No specific allegations regarding faculty conduct were made to the review committee. However, the sense was expressed more than once that there have been numerous instances of discrimination and harassment towards graduate students in the department, and that a lack of accountability and a fear of retaliation have led some students to feel that the department (and the discipline more generally) is "not a safe space" for them.

One of the primary goals of the faculty should be to build on structures that have already been put in place to improve relations with graduate students. Graduate students want a more formal role in shaping departmental procedures, norms, and expectations regarding graduate and undergraduate education. Department leadership also needs to understand that there is a body of recent alumni who feel very strongly that they were mistreated during their time in the program. It is difficult to know how many former students feel this way. However, it is clear that it would be much more in the interest of the program to engage with these alumni, rather than considering them to be no longer part of the community, and therefore outside of consideration.

Finally, while the autonomy of individual faculty labs is an important component of academic freedom in the department, the fact remains that very few EEB graduate students are funded through individual faculty grants. Because it is the department, and not individual faculty, that funds students through TA-ships and fellowships, the department has a right, and arguably an obligation, to assert greater central control over graduate education. It was framed for the review committee that after the first year, 95% of a student's experience in the program will depend upon their relationship with their advisor. The

department must do more to manage this. Otherwise, no matter what improvements may occur, it is likely that any future crisis, regardless of its origin, will cause faculty-student relations to deteriorate again, as happened in the Spring of 2024. The department will not be able to improve its culture if a significant number of graduate students continue to feel alienated and suspicious.

4. POSTDOCTORAL SCHOLARS

Strengths and Achievements

The data on the number of postdoctoral trainees indicates the program is of high quality. However, there was little in the self-report to make specific comments about these trainees.

Areas in Need of Attention

It was voiced that there are few opportunities within the department for professional development outside of opportunities within a specific lab setting. One consideration the department should make is to create a document of available resources for postdoctoral trainees that could be dispersed or investigate what other departments within life sciences do to aid in professional development for these trainees.

There is currently no faculty liaison with postdoctoral trainees. This is especially important for international trainees as there was no communication from leadership about changes in funding and visa requirements for these students following changes made by the Federal government in January, 2025.

5. FACULTY

Strengths and Achievements

EEB faculty are highly productive researchers in a range of fields, including (as per the self-review) conservation biology and genomics, plant physiology, population and community ecology, behavioral ecology, evolutionary biology, and marine and tropical biology. The outside reviewers' report gives a good sense of the research excellence of the faculty as evaluated by experts in the discipline. During the review period, individual faculty have been recognized for their achievements by a number of distinctions, including the election of three faculty members to the American Academy of Arts and Sciences. Many faculty have also been elected to or served in leadership roles within professional societies in their disciplines. UCLA has distinguished the teaching excellence of the EEB faculty with recognitions such as the Gold Shield Faculty Prize, two Distinguished Teaching Awards, and several Life Sciences Excellence in Teaching Awards. Members of the EEB faculty have also served in leadership roles at UCLA, including as Dean of Life Sciences, the Director of CEILS, and the Equity Advisor for Life Sciences.

The department has recruited excellent junior faculty during the review period, and these faculty members report strong levels of satisfaction with the support they have received from the department as they have set up their labs and begun their careers at UCLA. It is the review team's understanding

that junior faculty have been sheltered from much of the turmoil and division that has beset the department over the past five years.

Areas in Need of Attention

There is a pervasive sense that conflicts within the department, one of which has been repeatedly covered in national media publications, have caused "reputational damage" to the department as a whole, and to individual faculty members. There is also a sense that this damage has been made worse by the fact that university policies regarding confidentiality in personnel matters have prevented UCLA, EEB, and individual faculty from responding to allegations and misinformation reported in the press. These events have had a predictably severe effect on morale, with many faculty "retreating to their labs," "setting up walls," and otherwise disengaging from the department and colleagues to protect themselves.

Faculty recruitment and retention takes on a different meaning in this context, since any departure or failed search can be interpreted as further evidence of the department's toxic culture or dysfunction, which in turn amplifies the reputational damage and further erodes morale. For this reason, EEB must be given the resources it needs to retain current faculty and recruit new faculty. The department anticipates a number of retirements over the next eight years, and it already has a relatively small number of FTE and a high student-faculty ratio.

Hiring new faculty, if conducted through processes that include the input of all interested constituencies, can be one way to mend divisions within the department. Hiring should focus on junior-level positions. Decisions about desired specializations should be made with an emphasis on potential contributions to the undergraduate curricula, with the needs of the field research components in mind.

6. EQUITY, DIVERSITY, AND INCLUSION

Strengths and Achievements

By nearly every university metric, EEB has established a diverse academic community. Careful attention to hiring and recruitment has helped the department build a diverse and academically excellent faculty. The development of holistic admissions policies over the previous eight years has enabled the department to recruit a diverse graduate student body that aligns with the department's areas of research strength. The point was made to the review committee that the department has also been particularly good at recruiting and supporting graduate students from non-traditional academic backgrounds. In the undergraduate majors, graduation rates have increased over the review period, while time-to-degree averages have decreased. Although there are disparities between URM and non-URM, and first-gen and non-first-gen undergraduates across the department's three majors, these disparities are relatively small. The self-review notes that there are achievement gaps between URM and non-URM students in the Biology major, but the report also notes that some of these gaps may be explained by disparities that begin in the LS core curriculum. It notes that developing Biology-specific core courses in Chemistry and Physics, in tandem with the innovative Calculus courses for Biology majors that have opened since the previous review, may help to address these disparities.

The creation of a Vice Chair for Community, and a Committee on Anti-Racism and Equity (CARE) are another indication of the department's commitment to fostering an equitable and inclusive culture. The Vice Chair for Academic Personnel has established many written protocols and standard operating procedures to help ensure equity in the academic review process. In addition, over the review period, four members of the faculty have been recognized by the UCLA Academic Senate with EDI awards, and faculty have also been involved in nationally-recognized programs that seek to create more diverse, equitable, and inclusive STEM fields.

Areas in Need of Attention

It is noteworthy that despite the achievements listed above, there remains a perception among many in the department that there are entrenched, widespread inequities and disparities and a climate in which patterns of harassment and retaliation go unredressed. Some of this gap between the efforts that the department has made and the perception of the department's culture, could be reduced by better and more consistent communication: not all members of the department are aware of all the changes that the department has been making.

One area that will merit particular attention is in teaching equity. There is a perception that teaching responsibilities are not distributed equitably, and that there are inconsistent procedures and spotty communication around the assignment of courses, particularly at the undergraduate level. Even basic definitions, such as what constitutes a teaching assignment or an average teaching load, remain unclear to most faculty. It is in the department's interest to generate data about teaching labor, including information on how many courses faculty teach, where in the curriculum those courses fall, how course loads reductions are determined, and how courses are assigned, in the service of developing policies and procedures that distribute this labor more fairly and transparently. Focusing attention on teaching and the curriculum will also help to address concerns that the quality of instruction has declined over time. Currently, fewer faculty teach required courses, and more courses, particularly field courses, are being assigned to instructors who lack the expertise or training to teach them effectively.

7. STAFF AND RESOURCES

Strengths and Achievements

The self-study made it clear that there are significant challenges with high staff turnover within the department. The issue was not completely under the department's control, as the reorganization aimed to streamline services by decentralizing administrative functions resulted in increased workloads. There was recognition that the ongoing staffing issues have resulted in a strained departmental culture, particularly between faculty and staff. Faculty have felt the quality of services has left critical gaps in support for our department's academic mission. Staff morale has been impacted by increased workloads and have reported feeling overwhelmed and undervalued. That the department recognizes that this is a priority to address is a strength as they are committed to resolving these issues.

A major strength voiced by many faculty and staff was the new hire of the CAO Shannon McClenton. She has been instrumental in raising staff morale and providing them with support and knowledge. There was some concern that the department was not taking full advantage of her skill sets, but this appears to be changing daily given that she has not been with the department very long.

Areas in Need of Attention

Extremely high staff turnover has been a chronic issue in the department. From the perspective of the staff, this partly due to the culture within the department. With new compliance requirements and several layers of approval required to complete a task, the administrative burden is high (not unique to this department). However, faculty have been taking their frustration out on staff and have been prickly about the process of compliance. This has made it difficult to maintain a positive culture within the staff team members. The chair should address these issues directly with all faculty.

The perceived shortage of staff members was a concern raised by both staff and faculty. There is only one academic personnel coordinator, who has now been with the department for 2 months, but this position was vacant for over a year prior to the recent hire. A further concern was raised that new faculty hires are planned without consideration for a change in staff members, which are already stretched thin. The Dean and higher administration need to address these concerns to mitigate continued staff turnover, which leads to low productivity due to the time it takes for new staff members to learn the position.

8. RECOMMENDATIONS

Conclusion:

The Department of Ecology and Evolutionary Biology is a cornerstone department in the Division of Life Sciences, serving a large number of students and interfacing with a wide range of other units in the division and on campus. It has faced a series of extraordinary difficulties during the review period, and especially since 2020. With the benefit of effective and stable leadership, it has made admirable advances in the long process of rebuilding its culture and sense of community. The upper administration at UCLA should understand that every decision made about this department, regardless of the reason or intention, is liable to be interpreted in the context of the reputational damage that the department has sustained. Therefore, decisions need to be made very carefully with this context in mind. The department needs resources and support to continue its work of rebuilding and maintaining its high levels of research and teaching excellence, particularly in regard to its field research courses at the graduate and undergraduate levels. As the external evaluators' report states, "sustaining and renewing the excellence of EEB is essential to UCLA's pre-eminence in the life sciences."

Recommendations to the Dean:

1. Authorize EEB to begin building its faculty back to its historic norm of 35. Some new positions could be dedicated teaching faculty, designed in coordination with CEILS. Hiring should focus on junior level positions, and potential contributions to the undergraduate curricula should be a high priority in designating areas of research specialization.

2. Authorize hiring of two FTE staff positions to support operations within the department.

3. Work with EEB leadership and other relevant university offices to create a forum or context in which the department can have meaningful discussions about issues and conflicts that have occurred over the past five years.

Recommendations to the Department Chair

1. Initiate a comprehensive Academic Strategic Planning Process for the department, with input from all relevant department constituencies, focused on curriculum innovation and pedagogy. Graduate education, field research courses, and the undergraduate Biology major, should be prioritized.

2. Design and implement a formal mentorship training program for faculty who work with graduate students, in collaboration with on campus partners such as CEILS.

3. Design and implement a field safety training program for instructors assigned to teach field research courses.

4. Pilot a study to evaluate teaching labor in the department, with a view to creating policies and procedures that distribute teaching more equitably and transparently.

Final Recommendation: The Academic Program Review Committee recommends that **the Progress Review Meeting should not be waived**. The Progress Review Meeting should be held in Spring 2026.

Respectfully Submitted,

Michael Cohen Review Team Chair, Academic Program Review Committee, English
Catherine Cahill, Academic Program Review Committee, Psychiatry and Biobehavioral Sciences

Appendix I: External Reviewers' Report

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Berkeley Rausser
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DAVID D. ACKERLY, OFFICE OF THE DEAN

April 23, 2025

Dear Colleagues,

The Department of Ecology and Evolutionary Biology at UCLA has a distinguished history as a nationally ranked department spanning critical disciplines of the life sciences, ranging from marine biogeochemistry, to animal behavior, to conservation genomics. The areas encompassed within EEB continue to grow in importance, providing the critical discoveries and training of the next generation to tackle challenges of infectious disease, biodiversity loss, and global change. Sustaining and renewing the excellence of EEB is essential to UCLA's pre-eminence in the life sciences, and its broader mission as a distinguished campus of the University of California and a leader in American higher education.

This letter constitutes the external reviewer report for the 2025 academic program review of the EEB department. We have elected to write a joint letter, reflecting our consensus views on the critical strengths and challenges facing the department. The site visit occurred on April 8-9, and we had the opportunity to speak with faculty, staff, post-docs, graduate students, and undergraduates of the department, as well as campus leadership and internal reviewers representing the UCLA Academic Senate. We want to express our deep appreciation for the department's efforts in assembling a wide-ranging self-study, the campus hospitality, and the information shared by all who met with us. We begin our report with a more detailed review of the department's strengths, then address a singular set of events and challenges that frame this moment, and in that context address strengths, opportunities and recommendations for the future.

Strengths

EEB has a distinguished academic history of research excellence, undergraduate education, and training of graduate students who have become noted scholars in their fields. Academically, the department has had wide-ranging impacts in multiple fields in ecology, evolution, and behavior. EEB has been a historical center of excellence in the study of Biodiversity Science, including genomics of diversification, both at micro and macroevolutionary scales, and the application of genomics to the field of conservation biology. The department has also distinguished itself in the fields of animal behavior, marine biology, infectious disease, physiological ecology, community ecology, and global change. In terms of representative areas, this department is broad, and all the current faculty research portfolios address modern and timely questions in the study of ecology, evolution, and behavior. In

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undergraduate education, EEB has built and earned a well-deserved reputation for its commitment to field-based education, centered on the role of the Field and Marine Biology Quarter (FBQ/MBQ) classes that are required components of the Ecology, Behavior and Evolution, and the Marine Biology majors. For students enrolling in these 16-unit classes, it is their only course for the semester, and in a given semester they may be based at field stations from Bodega Bay in Northern California to French Polynesia. The hands-on, project-based training in these classes provides both transformative educational experiences and exceptional preparation for advanced study in ecology, evolution, and related fields.

The department also supports the large Biology major, which plays a key role in meeting the exceptional demand for life sciences majors among UCLA undergraduates. In this endeavor they are supported by CIELS, a Center that drives pedagogical change to increase equity, diversity and inclusion in STEM. The department is fortunate to have the CIELS director serving as a Teaching Professor in EEB. At the graduate level, EEB's academic excellence has been mirrored by a tradition of high-quality PhD education, good metrics in terms of student performance and progress during their PhD, and high placement of PhD students in STEM related jobs, both within and outside of academia. EEB faculty are also noteworthy for their service and leadership contributions both within the university and in our scientific community more broadly. In the last decade EEB faculty have received state and federal recognition through various awards for excellence in research, leadership in professional societies, teaching excellence, and leadership in DEI Initiatives. Faculty have also served in critical positions in campus leadership.

A Singular Moment of Challenge

The decade since EEB's 2015 review has, and continues to be, particularly tumultuous in higher education. EEB has been impacted by national events, particularly COVID, Black Lives Matter, and last year's political protests, and by the UC-specific academic employee strike. In addition, the department has been deeply impacted by a singularly divisive controversy due to public charges of discriminatory culture and actions levied by a faculty member. We are well aware of the restrictions the university faces to openly address such a case due to legal and policy constraints. However, we cannot in good conscience attempt to write our report and elide the impacts of these events and the central role they play in both the evaluation of the last ten years, and recommendations for the future. **We are in no way addressing the merits of arguments advanced by any party. Rather, we deem it essential for the university administration to support the department in finding a path forward that can acknowledge harm, and support a process of reconciliation among community members, as a foundation for the future.** The publicity surrounding the case has caused permanent damage to individual scientific careers, and deep and lasting reputational harm to EEB and UCLA. EEB's continued preeminence, and capacity to recruit and retain the best

faculty, students, and staff, require some mechanism to acknowledge and address these harms, while respecting necessary restrictions due to personnel policy and individual rights. This is not an easy task. It is also important to avoid the temptation to frame all issues in the context of a single episode or set of individual relationships. Potential underlying systemic biases and cultural norms must be acknowledged as the broader context within which the more recent incidents have occurred.

In this context, we want to highlight the exceptional efforts of Dean Johnson, Chair Alfaro, and current department leadership to chart this path forward. From 2020 to 2022, the department was kept afloat by external leadership, doing what was possible under almost impossible circumstances. While much remains to be done, we heard from individuals across the department a deep appreciation for the efforts of current leadership, and the many reparative steps underway to put the department on a new footing. One of the greatest challenges faced by leadership is policy restrictions that do not allow for open discussion of the real harm and tensions within the department, and the external reputational damage. We reiterate the necessity to find ways to acknowledge harm and allow for discussion, while respecting personnel policy.

We want to particularly highlight that newly hired faculty and staff, and recently recruited graduate students, expressed more optimistic views on department culture, as they have been protected from the most problematic aspects of the events of the last decade. A path forward that allows for greater reconciliation among community members (including those who have departed or graduated), without reopening past wounds or unnecessarily demanding engagement from newer members of the department, will be a challenging but essential task.

Undergraduate Curriculum and Teaching

EEB oversees the Biology Major, which is the 4th largest major on campus and provides a foundational education for a large number of pre-health majors and other students with broad interests in biology. In addition, EEB also oversees two smaller majors in Marine Biology (MB) and Ecology, Behavior, and Evolution (EBE). These smaller majors include 16 credit capstone Field/Marine Biology Quarter courses which are nationally known as premier field experiential learning opportunities, and an important aspect of the identity of the department. Numerous faculty have demonstrated their commitment to the majors by dedicating exceptional time as instructors in these courses. Undergraduate students who have taken the Field or Marine Quarter courses routinely refer to that opportunity as “transformative” to their careers.

The Bio majors that EEB oversees continue to grow in enrollment, and the perception from the faculty is that the resources (both in teaching personnel and budgets) have not kept track with enrollments. This same point was raised by the 2015 review team and represents a decadal and ongoing challenge for the department. The Field and Marine Quarter courses may be

particularly at risk because they are expensive to teach and are capped in terms of total participation. The uncertainty that underlies the teaching of these courses could be exacerbated by budget models that favor student enrollment numbers alone, and therefore do not value the deeper experiential learning methods that are so impactful in smaller field-based courses.

In our meeting with undergraduates, all of whom were EBE majors, they reiterated the value of the Field/Marine Biology Quarters for their career development, and mentioned the FBQ/MBQ small class sizes and direct engagement in research as the highlights of their time at UCLA. However, aside from those courses, the students complained about the difficulty of finding courses that were small (<100 enrolled) and other courses that included more hands-on activities. They highlighted specifically that the marine biology majors were having a hard time meeting course requirements, and that generally many courses for advanced students were not being offered in recent years. We presume that these shortfalls are a result of increased enrollment, the loss/retirement/departure of faculty who taught those courses, and the fact that many of the more senior members of the department have taken on administrative roles that reduce their teaching.

We see a few areas where the department could improve the overall experiences of an undergraduate at UCLA in any of the Bio majors. First, if the Field Biology Quarters are to be maintained, the department needs to work carefully with administration to develop a financial and instructional model that can sustain them. Field courses are expensive and given the financial uncertainties at all levels in the university this may require some creative reshaping of the undergraduate curriculum. For example, the smaller MB and EBE majors might be open to more students by adopting a two-pronged approach, with some students enrolling in a typical FBQ/MBQ and others in a version that was still experiential but less field intensive. One could imagine a semester equivalent of the FBQ or MBQ that focused on “tracks” with research experiences in computational biology, sustainability, or genomics, for example. In these alternate tracks, students would still gain real experiences, but not necessarily with the same field focus. These decisions on undergraduate curriculum should be made through a shared process of evaluating the undergraduate core curriculum and equitable faculty teaching workload, to help cover the needs of an ever-growing student body. Our understanding is that the department is engaged in considering these challenges and finding new options going forward, and we urge the administration to support these efforts.

We also discussed with undergraduate students their experiences in the program in terms of research opportunities, and climate in their classrooms and labs. Most of the students we interviewed were actively engaged in field and lab work with EEB PIs, and they expressed appreciation for those opportunities. We were discouraged to find that at least some of the undergraduates were well aware of difficulties springing from department culture, specifically

from witnessing the impact of that culture on their graduate student mentors. Although not all undergraduates will have this experience, those embedded in labs are witnessing the negative impacts and they stated that this has negatively affected their decisions to continue on to graduate school as a next career step, and specifically some said they would not apply for graduate studies in EEB or recommend that others do. That the undergraduates are not immune from the trickle-down effect of departmental culture clearly shows the importance of addressing the core issues at the higher levels in the department.

The Graduate Program

Number of Students, Student Quality, and Post Graduation Placement
The data on student numbers, awards, and post-doctoral placement indicate that the EEB Graduate Program retains the high quality of research training it has demonstrated in the past. Per the EEB self study, the graduate program has enrolled on average 13 PhD students and 8 MS students each year over the last decade. These students complete their degrees in a period of time that is typical of programs in this field (about six years), and they move on to productive jobs within and outside of academia. By the numbers, we do not see any red flags for how the program is operating in terms of these metrics of student performance as they move through the program. We did identify a few challenges related to funding, and the trade-offs between funding rates and student numbers. The last decade has been challenging in terms of increasing student salaries while balancing the size of graduate cohorts, yet salaries have increased consistently over the last six years. This challenge has been especially acute for the recruitment of international students, who receive no out-of-state waivers, and thus must be supported at a higher cost. Our understanding is that UC policy allows individual campuses to determine how many years of non-resident tuition must be paid on behalf of international students, and we urge UCLA administration to consider reducing this burden. There is always room for graduate salary improvement, especially in southern California where cost of living is high. Assuming no changes in resources invested in the program, with salaries increasing, the number of students will necessarily decrease, and the number of times students will need to TA will increase, potentially leading to less productive research training experiences for the students. This challenge of funding a vibrant (and hopefully growing) program will be a continuous one, and the department and administration should carefully watch for tipping points that might lead to quantitative decreases in the quality of the program.

Student Feedback: A Range of Experiences Among Students
In contrast to the research training outcomes reported for the EEB Program, the experiences of graduate students in the program in terms of mentoring, culture, and wellbeing are highly variable, and show a need for continued and consistent efforts toward positive change. While acknowledging that current leadership is making efforts to improve culture through transparency in communication and procedures, many students reported significant lack of trust that the program has their best interest as a priority. The department's recommended

adoption of mentoring compacts is particularly noteworthy. We applaud the department for taking this step, which is in line with emerging and evidence-based best practices. However, students viewed the compacts and their expectations as insufficiently structured, with no guidelines for adoption, no incentives or enforcement for mentors who adopt or not, resulting in more variability among labs. Students agreed that the enforcement of an annual committee meeting was an important step but stated that this might not be enough. Overall many students (especially the more senior students) expressed a wish for more structured policies that guarantee a more holistic mentorship model. Our conclusion is that for some fraction of the students, the lack of concerted mentorship efforts, combined with very low interactions with other faculty and lab groups has led to a sense of isolation and low overall morale in the graduate student body.

We realize that there are many factors, both internal and external, that have contributed to this situation. The actions and efforts that have been put into place by the current leadership are already showing positive effects. We heard from some of the more recently admitted students that they were having a very positive experience in the program and they held optimistic views for its future. Now is the time to double down on those efforts. Restoring a sense of community and trust will take intentional and consistent implementation of best practices in community building, communication, advising, and professional development opportunities.

We did not meet with any students in the Biology or Evolutionary Medicine MS Programs, so we cannot report whether their experiences are similar to those reported by the PhD students.

Graduate Curriculum

The graduate student curriculum has been in flux with the turnover in faculty due to retirements, departures, and new hires. Students would like to have more opportunities to take innovative courses and specifically requested more topical seminar style graduate offerings (these would also serve to increase student/faculty interaction). Overall, the curriculum could use some close examination to make sure that the offerings are up-to-date and meet the training requirements of the students currently in the program. This evaluation of the graduate curriculum could be part of the same teaching and workload assessment recommended in the Undergraduate Teaching section.

Recommendations

The main complaint from graduate students was the lack of consistent and holistic mentoring. By holistic mentoring, they mean mentoring that includes all aspects of student experiences, including their safety in the lab and in the field, attention to wellbeing and sense of belonging, mentoring that is culturally aware and adapted to the needs of students at different stages. The self study mentions faculty engagement in CIMER training, and one possible avenue to increase mentoring awareness is to ask that all members of the department engage in that training and intentionally apply those practices in their graduate student interactions.

The department might reinforce these best mentoring practices with more clarity in expectations for mentor engagement, and more formalized procedures for keeping mentors active and engaged in the progress of their students. Some examples might include:

• Requiring that mentors create and revisit Independent Development Plans (IDP) with their students at the start of every semester.

• Producing skill development plans for 1st year students to connect them with resources they need.

• Incentivizing grass root “working groups” that include faculty, post-docs, and graduate students that choose to focus on some aspect of community improvement they care about and providing them with resources.

• Assign a task force led by the Vice Chair for Graduate Education (or Community) and graduate student members that surveys all graduate students on what good mentorship should look like (in detail), summarize those mentorship standards, and discuss those recommendations with faculty and at townhalls with graduate students.

A second area highlighted by the students was the sense that they were “on their own” and not part of a community. The fact that students interact very little with faculty outside of their labs was a common theme. More emphasis on social interactions would benefit the department as a whole. Social interactions are not only defined as parties or events, but can also be achieved through shared governance, such as participation of graduate students on committees or working groups, or through other opportunities such as graduate seminars. Any activity where departmental members share, and work toward, a common goal will generate a sense of community. The department has made significant investments in this area, and we strongly support and endorse a continued commitment to rebuilding community and strengthening student-faculty trust and engagement.

Facilities, Administration, and Finance

EEB faculty are spread across three buildings, one fairly new (Terasaki), one recently renovated (Botany), and one facing very significant facilities and health and safety issues (LSB). The renovation of the La Kretz Botany Building was completed since the last review, and has greatly improved the facilities and research environment for plant biology faculty occupying the space. While we did not tour LSB, the self-study and faculty interviews indicate very significant concerns, which are well known to the administration. The issue that alarmed us the most was that the building is not useable to provide space for newly recruited faculty, coupled with impacts on the research programs of faculty in the building. While the costs of renovation or replacement may be prohibitive, we would advocate strongly for the Dean and campus to seek space for EEB in other buildings, to ensure that this issue does not become a limit to future faculty recruitment and strategic department growth (see Strategic Planning, below). Faculty also shared that the renovation of the seawater system was a critical and deeply appreciated investment in support of marine biology, but expressed concern that marine teaching facilities still face issues. We did not tour space so can only reinforce our

support for continued investment in support of this critical part of the departmental mission and EEB's unique strengths in undergraduate education.

One of the single greatest concerns we heard from multiple faculty, and also discussed in the self-study, was very high turnover rates of staff over the past five years. This has been due, in part, to post-COVID turmoil and the common university problem that staff seeking advancement usually succeed only by applying to positions in other units. However, indirect evidence suggests, unsurprisingly, that the department's climate challenges, issues with faculty who have not treated staff respectfully, and turnover in leadership have also made the work environment very difficult for staff. Moreover, the turnover undermines working relationships among staff and faculty, and implementation of new systems (such as UCPath) has reduced staff productivity. Together, these lead to low satisfaction for staff and frustration from faculty, a vicious cycle as staff do not feel supported and respected for their work.

Against that backdrop, it is evident the department has made significant steps forward, with committed faculty leadership, and the recruitment of an experienced department manager, who is building a stable and skilled staff team. Faculty leadership are modeling for their peers the importance of respectful and productive working relationships with staff. We cannot overstate the importance of sustaining the current arrangement, and hope the faculty will give their full support to the current staff and appreciate the opportunities for process improvement drawing on their experience in other units. We did not have access to comparative data on staff:faculty ratios or other workload metrics, and we know that no department in most public universities has as many staff as they deserve or would like. However, we were left with the strong impression that the EEB staff are still critically short of FTE and any way that the university could resource additional investment would have significant value for the department.

In the self-study and faculty interviews, many concerns were raised about the rollout of a proposed BruinBudget model, which would standardize departmental funding primarily on student credit hour and enrollment metrics. If implemented, our understanding is that it would help to correct long-standing underfunding of Life Sciences, but EEB felt it would undermine their commitment to field teaching due to the small class sizes and high faculty effort required. Those in leadership seemed confident that the model would not be implemented, and that concerns were unfounded. However, having seen similar discussions unfold on one of our campuses, we find the concerns quite rational, especially because curriculum planning has a long time horizon which is difficult under uncertainty. Moreover, there will always be pressure on how to fund research-based, hands-on education, especially for off-campus field work with high associated costs. We urge the administration to reaffirm its commitment to EEB's unique strengths in field education and, as discussed above, urge the department faculty to engage more with the structure and value of the Biology major, so the large enrollments can help support the overall teaching mission.

Academic Strategic Planning

Our primary recommendation is that the department embark on a comprehensive Academic Strategic Planning process, as a foundation for the future. This process should be professionally facilitated, and we urge the Dean's Office to assist in providing the necessary support and campus engagement. A strong commitment of all faculty, with appropriate contributions of students and staff, is essential. A strategic plan should address, at a minimum, four key areas, and it would also provide an opportunity to address challenges identified elsewhere in this report:

1) Academic Priorities: The department self-study, while comprehensive in some regards, did not devote sufficient attention to the current disciplinary balance of the faculty and priorities for future hiring (beyond the broad commitment to support Marine Biology and other immediate needs). As part of a planning process, we hope the department would take stock of current faculty strengths in relation to evolving opportunities and emerging frontiers in ecology, evolution, and behavior. A key strategic question for any academic unit is balancing areas of concentrated excellence vs. comprehensive breadth. We urge the department to find a distinctive mission and vision that complement peer departments and build a multi-year hiring plan towards that vision. Planning should also evaluate the unique opportunities afforded by both the campus and regional context, such as stronger partnerships with the Medical School, the DataX initiative, local field stations, the LA urban environment, and others.
2) Curriculum: The second area is a careful evaluation of the curriculum, with a special eye to the balance of traditional approaches to teaching EEB vs. emerging fields, and opportunities for interdisciplinary integration with other units on campus (e.g. data sciences). It is clear that the faculty are deeply committed to the MB and EBE majors, while the very large Biology major seemed to take a back seat. The continued success and high enrollments of the Biology major is clearly essential to maintain the department's proportional contribution to Life Sciences, and merits careful attention. Working with CIELS provides excellent opportunities to evaluate pedagogy and learning goals in all majors. Sustaining the commitment to the field quarters, already discussed above, is clearly central, while also considering how to prevent these courses from creating a de facto cap on the size of the MB and EBE majors, where there may be growing interest. A curriculum review should also entail a careful workload analysis and establishment of a clear teaching load policy and a shared commitment by faculty to make adjustments as needed to ensure equitable workloads.
3) Community: Our hope is that the common purpose arising from a focus on academic and curricular priorities could provide the foundation required for the continuing and difficult work of addressing climate challenges in the department. We have recommended above that the campus support explicit efforts to address harms and restorative community building. This is work that would clearly require professional facilitation, and we do not have the expertise to provide further specificity on what form this work might take.

4) Facilities and finances: A comprehensive strategic plan also provides the foundation to identify space needs and facilities priorities, and consider any opportunities for new revenue sources that could strengthen the department's financial foundation.

We are well aware that strategic planning requires a significant commitment of time and effort, and we hope the department faculty, leadership, and campus administration embrace this recommendation and assemble the necessary resources to ensure a successful outcome that will pave the way for the department's continued success.

Summary

In closing, as external reviewers we were impressed with the following aspects of EEB at UCLA:

• Strong research portfolio across the faculty, with a large diversity of fields represented, strong publication and service records among faculty.
• Recruitment of excellent graduate students and strong placement of those students at the end of their programs in academic and non-academic STEM positions.
• A continued dedication to undergraduate teaching in the Bio major, despite growing enrollment and reductions and turn over in faculty.
• A dedication to capstone experiential courses (MBQ, FBQ) that are transformative for student careers.

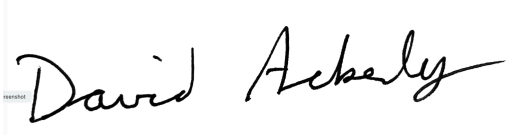
We also identified pressing needs that should be addressed to maximize the department's potential:

• The department has struggled to recover from many years of challenging climate issues, impacting the morale of all members and their engagement in the community. Moving forward will require critical self-evaluation of the behaviors and potential biases that may have contributed to the current situation, and the changes needed to move forward. To be successful this process will require accountability and shared responsibility for outcomes of any improvement efforts moving forward.
• Graduate student mentoring needs to be improved overall, so that students have more uniform experiences in mentoring and more equal access to mentorship and mentoring resources that maximize their advancement in the PhD program. We strongly support the department's mentoring compact initiative, and recommend continued efforts to implement best-practices in mentoring with the explicit objective of reducing the high variability in mentorship quality that students receive in the department.
• The department is in need of a well thought-out strategic plan that focuses on hiring and retaining young faculty and rebuilding the historically strong areas of research and forging new ones. This will require continued investment in terms of faculty lines, space, and resources.

• The undergraduate and graduate curricula are in need of re-assessment to make sure that the number and topics of classes meet the requirements for the majors and are responsive to developments in the disciplines, and for graduate education ensuring adequate graduate level seminars and training to strengthen faculty-student interactions and advanced training.

We thank you for the opportunity to review the Department of Ecology and Evolutionary Biology. We appreciate everyone who took time to help us understand the complexities of how the department is functioning currently in terms of overall operations, research, teaching, and climate. We hope our recommendations are useful and we look forward to continued improvements and success in all areas in the near future.

Sincerely,



David Ackerly
Dean, Rausser College of Natural Resources
University of California, Berkeley

Kelly R. Zamudio
Associate Chair of Graduate Education, College of Natural Sciences
Department of Integrative Biology
University of Texas at Austin

Appendix II: Site Visit Schedule

UCLA Academic Senate
Program Review

Program Review Site Visit Schedule:
Department of Ecology and Evolutionary Biology
Site Visit Dates: April 8-9, 2025

Review Team

Michael Cohen, Review Team Chair, Academic Program Review Committee, English
Catherine Cahill, Academic Program Review Committee, Psychiatry and Biobehavioral Sciences
David Ackerly, Integrative Biology, University of California, Berkeley
Kelly Zamudio, Integrative Biology, University of Texas at Austin

Tuesday, April 8, 2025			
Start	**End**	**Meeting**	**Location**
8:00am	8:50am	Breakfast with Chair Michael Alfaro	Plateia
9:00am	9:30am	Vice Chair of Graduate Affairs Morgan Tingley	164 Hershey Hall
9:30am	10:00am	Vice Chair of Undergraduate Affairs Paul Barber	164 Hershey Hall
10:00am	10:30am	Vice Chair of Community Nathan Kraft	164 Hershey Hall
10:30am	11:00am	Administrative Team	164 Hershey Hall
11:00am	11:30am	Graduate Students	164 Hershey Hall
11:30am	12:00pm	Undergraduate Students	164 Hershey Hall
12:00pm	1:30pm	Lunch (Review Team Only)	Faculty Club
1:30pm	2:00pm	Post Docs	164 Hershey Hall
2:00pm	2:45pm	Discussion of DEI (Vice Chairs)	164 Hershey Hall
2:45pm	3:00pm	Break	
3:00pm	3:45pm	Confidential Meetings	3135 Murphy Hall + Zoom
3:45pm	4:00pm	Break	
4:00pm	5:00pm	Closed Session (Review Team Only)	3135 Murphy Hall
Wednesday, April 9, 2025			
Start	**End**	**Meeting**	**Location**
8:00am	8:30am	Closed Session (Review Team Only)	1215 Murphy Hall
8:30am	9:00am	Dean Tracy Johnson	1215 Murphy Hall
9:00am	11:30am	Confidential Meetings	1215 Murphy Hall + Zoom
11:30am	12:00pm	Early Career Faculty	1215 Murphy Hall + Zoom
12:00pm	1:30pm	Lunch (Review Team Only)	Faculty Club
1:30pm	2:00pm	Mid-Senior Career Faculty	1215 Murphy Hall + Zoom

2:00pm	3:00pm	Closed Session (Review Team Only)	1215 Murphy Hall
3:15pm	3:45pm	Final Meeting with Academic Unit Chair	1215 Murphy Hall
4:00pm	**5:00pm**	**Exit Meeting –** Chair **Michael Alfaro**, Life Sciences Division Dean **Tracy Johnson**, Executive Vice Chancellor/Provost **Darnell Hunt**, Interim Vice Provost of Equity, Diversity, and Inclusion **Mitchell Chang**, Dean of Undergraduate Education **Adriana Galvan**, Dean of Graduate Education, Academic Program Review Committee Co-Chairs **Sarah Kareem** and **Gabriel Rossman**	**1215 Murphy Hall + Zoom**